

[Return to Search](#)

How a Hawiye tribe used to live

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Section Title(S)

C) Proverbs on the 'vaunt' of the tribes

4) *mâlin maráy kú härgál* '[unknown]awádaná
M[unknown]job[unknown]i[unknown]en túg!

186
[Cultural Identity And
Pride](#)

539
[Literary Texts](#)

619
[Tribe And Nation](#)

"You should spend midday under a maray tree and at night ask a
M[unknown]obil[unknown]en for hospitality!"

186
[Cultural Identity And
Pride](#)

539
[Literary Texts](#)

619
[Tribe And Nation](#)

The maray tree does not give shade because of its very scarce leaves, just as
the M[unknown]obil[unknown]en are scarcely hospitable because of their
notorious parsimony.

137
[Flora](#)

186

Cultural Identity And
Pride

539
Literary Texts

574
Visiting And
Hospitality

619
Tribe And Nation

5) *sírta Dínl[unknown]a Mantân íyyo[unknown] dûlka hôs la[unknown]gú
[unavailable]od[unknown]ay w[unknown]a[unknown]iss[unknown]û
[unknown]dêre .*

186
Cultural Identity And
Pride

539
Literary Texts

619
Tribe And Nation

"The astuteness of the Dîhlä Mant[unknown]an and the ground under which
one has dug are equally deep."

186
Cultural Identity And
Pride

539
Literary Texts

619
Tribe And Nation

The cunning of the Dinlä Mant[unknown]an proceeds underground like a
gallery dug under the ground, for instance, by the faranfär (the heterocephalus
glaber, the rodent so widespread in the Somalian woodland).

136
Fauna

186
Cultural Identity And
Pride

539
Literary Texts

619
Tribe And Nation

The Dinlä are one of the three major stirpes of the Mant[unknown]an
'Abdull[unknown]ah.

186
Cultural Identity And
Pride

539
Literary Texts

619
Tribe And Nation

280 6) *Barísä Mantân mâl la[unknown]gá hevhívo*
w[unknown]a[unknown]marôdi [unknown]gilâl 'âus[unknown]ay .

186
 Cultural Identity And
 Pride

539
 Literary Texts

619
 Tribe And Nation

"To ask the Barísä Mant[unknown]an for money is [like] an elephant that wants to feed on grass during the dry season."

186
 Cultural Identity And
 Pride

539
 Literary Texts

619
 Tribe And Nation

They joke about the attachment of the Barísä Mant[unknown]an to their goods. Naturally in dry weather the elephant will never find the quantity of grass needed by it and will have to emigrate elsewhere.

186
 Cultural Identity And
 Pride

539
 Literary Texts

619
 Tribe And Nation

7) *'árra 'ád bêr mahín. 'ar[unknown]otóy nâg mahín. 'ási wíl mahín. 'ambúlo sôr mahín. 'Áli 'Êli 'íd mahín .*

186
 Cultural Identity And
 Pride

539
 Literary Texts

619
 Tribe And Nation

"The white land is not a garden. The wife who runs away is not a wife. The disobedient one is not a son. The boiled durra is not polenta. The 'Ali '[unknown]Eli are not a tribe."

186
 Cultural Identity And
 Pride

539
 Literary Texts

619
 Tribe And Nation

The 'Ali '[unknown]Eli, one of the stirpes of the '[unknown]Eli 'Umar of the W[unknown]ar[unknown]s[unknown]e[unknown]h zone, are thus mocked.

186
Cultural Identity And
Pride

539
Literary Texts

619
Tribe And Nation

The 'white land' is the desert zone immediately beyond that of the coastal dune, where the sandy terrain does not permit cultivation, but only pasture.

186
Cultural Identity And
Pride

311
Land Use

539
Literary Texts

619
Tribe And Nation

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